

755 Prepared Speech

(formerly 545)

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will research a business, leadership, or professional development topic and deliver a well-organized speech demonstrating effective verbal and nonverbal communication skills. Evaluation will emphasize organization, delivery, audience engagement, ethical source use, and professionalism. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this judged event. The event may be repeated, but the topic may not be reused. A contestant may not participate in Prepared Speech, Presentation Individual or Industry Pitch Team in the same year.

Contestant Must Supply

- One (1) copy of the Speech Outline and Works Cited formatted according to the *Style & Reference Manual*, BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form for each round (prelims and finals)
- Optional - Easel, flipchart, posterboard and props

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Length of event: no more than one (1) minute setup, no less than five (5) and no more than seven (7) minutes for the speech
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Contest Competencies

1. Communicate ideas clearly, professionally, and confidently through effective speaking skills
2. Organize the speech using a clear introduction, body, and conclusion to create a coherent and engaging message
3. Use appropriate tempo, pitch, vocal variety, gestures, posture, and eye contact to support confident and professional delivery
4. Incorporate research, evidence, and credible sources to strengthen key points and support the overall message
5. Adapt content, tone, and delivery to meet the needs and expectations of the intended audience
6. Demonstrate professionalism and ethical communication by using original work, citing sources appropriately, and presenting respectfully
7. Prepare and submit a properly formatted Works Cited page that follows BPA's *Style & Reference Manual*
8. Prepare and submit a clear, well-organized outline that follows the BPA *Style & Reference Manual* format

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Contestant selects a topic related to business, entrepreneurship, or Business Professionals of America
- Facts and working data may be secured from any source. This event emphasizes a scholarly approach to securing information and places emphasis on content and research. Each contestant's speech, however, must be the result of his/her own efforts
- Contestants must place their Contestant ID in the top-right corner of the header on the Works Cited and Speech outline. (This addition is *not* noted in the *Style & Reference Manual*.)
- Business Professionals of America grants permission for the use of the copyrighted logo and tagline
- No materials other than the required submission may be left with judges

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- The contestant is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright laws. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestant(s) will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.



755 Prepared Speech
Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any questions result in a NO being checked, judges please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> below:				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-7 points	Meets Expectations 8-14 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Contestant rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Contestant occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Contestant maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/20
Organization, Design & Structure	The speech lacks coherence and the contestant's approach does not clearly convey a structured or purposeful flow.	The speech content has some gaps in organization, and the contestant's structure is occasionally unclear or inconsistent.	The speech content flows adequately, and the contestant demonstrates a clear and well-integrated structure throughout.	/20
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-30 points	Above Expectations 31-50 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	The speech demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	The speech demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	The speech demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/50
Timing & Documentation	Setup lasted no longer than one (1) minute, speech lasted no less than five (5) minutes and no longer than seven (7) minutes. Speech Outline and Works Cited in the correct format according to the Style & Reference Manual, BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form were submitted at presentation check-in (both preliminaries and finals).			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

SPEECH WILL BE STOPPED AT SEVEN (7) MINUTES